



MEDIA COVERAGE REPORT

March 2026

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PRINT, ONLINE & SOCIAL MEDIA COVERAGE

Tyre Review

- **Total Coverage – 2**

Date	Publication	Headline	Edition
March 2026	Pune Mirror	Eurogrip Climber XC Tyre Review	National
March 2026	Pune Mirror	Eurogrip Climber XC Off Road King	National

Industry Story

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23-Mar-2025	The Times of India	Tyre makers move up the value chain – via TN	Chennai
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Tyre Review

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March 2026	Pune Mirror(MAT)	Eurogrip Climber XC Tyre Review	8 -9	National

EUROGRIP CLIMBER XC TYRE REVIEW

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For the past few months we have been testing the 90/90-21 (front) and the 120/90-18 (rear) of the Eurogrip Climber XC tyre range. They were equipped on our Hero Xpulse 200 that also has the factory-fitted rally kit. Before we begin, we must point out that these are primarily off-road tyres and are not designed for use on paved surfaces.

Off-road:

If one is trying such tyres for the first time ever, it will be an unforgettable experience. A motorcycle that you were used to riding with dual-purpose rubber will feel like another machine on the same trails when equipped with the Climber XCs. It is more of an upgrade in confidence rather than anything else because the Climber's potential begins when dual-purpose units reach their limit. As far as soft ground is concerned, loose soil/sand is not much of a problem for such tyres, but slush and mud are trickier to manage. The Climber handles the latter effectively thanks to the depth of its blocks.

As long as there is steady throttle input, mud gets flung off quickly and the rear tyre finds grip almost instantly. What stands out is that the

front tyre also fights off mud effectively which allows the rider more time and space to correct mistakes without sacrificing momentum. Over hard ground, the results are slightly different. Loose rocks and gravel are not troublesome for the Climber, but one has to be careful about hard ground and rocks whose surfaces are comparable to paved roads because such terrain is not optimal for these tyres.

Road:

These are not road tyres at all, simply because they are not designed for tarmac. In fact, spending up to 10 per cent of its life on paved surfaces is a stretch for the Climber. Riding on the road for a long time will not only drastically reduce the life of the tyre, but will also pose safety risks. There is plenty of usable grip from the rubber itself but the size and spacing of the blocks limits speed. The most amount of road riding one should be doing is riding the motorcycle slowly from one trail to the next.

Since we are running tubes inside these tyres, we have been dreading a puncture but we are glad to report that it has not happened yet. An India launch date for the Climber XC tyres is yet to be announced but writing to Eurogrip tyres showing interest could certainly speed things up a bit.



• Price: To be announced • Rating: 10/10

Date	Publication	Headline	Page	Edition
March 2026	Pune Mirror (MAT) - Hindi	Eurogrip Climber XC Off Road King	8 -9	National

EUROGRIP CLIMBER XC ऑफ रोड किंग!

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गेल्या काही महिन्यांपासून आम्ही १०/१०/२१ (फेड) आणि १२०/१०/१८ (रिअर) या Eurogrip Climber XC टायर्सची चाचणी घेत आहोत. हे टायर्स आपल्या Hero Xpulse 200 वर लावले होते. मागचे फेडरले-मिडेल रीबी किट आहे. हे प्रमुखपणे ऑफ रोड टायर्स आहेत आणि प्रकृषा रस्त्यांसाठी डिझाइन केलेले नाहीत. हे सुलवातीलाच स्पष्ट करणे आवश्यक आहे. पहिल्यांदाच आले टायर्स वापरण्यासाठी हा अनुभव अविस्मरणीय ठरेल. ब्रुअल-पॅज टायर्सवरील Climber XC लावल्यानंतर तीव्र मोटरसायकल पूर्णपणे वेगळी वाटते. हे मुख्यतः आल्फाविकास वाढवणारे अपरेड आहे. कारण जिथे ब्रुअल-पॅज टायर्स मर्यादेला पोहोचतात तिथून Climber ची खरी क्षमता सुरू होते. सेल माती किंवा वाळूत हे टायर्स सहज काम करताना; मात्र चिखल अधिक आव्हानात्मक असतो. खोल ट्रेड ब्लॉक्समुळे Climber चिखलातही चांगली पकड देतो. सतत ब्रॅटल

विल्यास चिखल लवकर फेकला जातो आणि मागील टायर लगेच विप मिळवतो. समोरील टायरही चिखलात प्रभावी कामगिरी करतो. यामुळे रायडरला चुका सुधारण्याची संधी मिळते. मात्र कडक पृष्ठभागावर, विशेषतः दुष्कळीत वगळावर अधिक काळजी घ्यावी लागते.

हे टायर्स सामान्य रस्त्यासाठी अजिबातही योग्य नाहीत. त्यांचा आयुष्यातील १० टक्क्यांहून अधिक वापर पक्क्या रस्त्यावर करणे योग्य ठरणार नाही. सामान्य रस्त्यावर खर्चकाळ वापरल्यास टायरचे आयुष्य कमी होते आणि सुरक्षेचा धोका निर्माण होतो. रबरमधून विप मिळतो, पण ब्लॉक्सच्या आकारामुळे वेग मर्यादित राहतो. एका टेलव्हर्न वुस्मावर जाण्यासाठी कमी वेगच चालवणेच योग्य ठरते.

या टायर्समध्ये ट्यूब वापरत असल्याने पंक्चरची भीती होती, मात्र अद्याप तसे अनुभव आलेला नाही. भारतातील लॉन्च तारीख जाहीर झालेली नसली तरी कंपनीला रस दर्शवणारे ईमेल पाठविल्यास प्रक्रिया वेगवान होऊ शकते.

- किंमत : जाहीर होणे बाकी
- रेटिंग : १०/१०



Industry Story

Date	Publication	Headline	Page	Edition
23-Mar-2026	The Times of India	Tyre makers move up the value chain – via TN	2	Chennai

Tyre makers move up the value chain—via TN

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Over the few years—especially in FY26—Tamil Nadu has witnessed a dynamic phase in tyre manufacturing, cementing its position as a key production hub for both domestic and global players. What began as additional capacity to serve OEM and replacement demand has evolved into flagship facilities within global networks, driving innovation, premiumisation, and export growth. The state now accounts for about one-fourth of India's tyre exports.

While TN has long been home to tyre makers such as MRF and TVS Srichakra (Eurogrip), other leading domestic players—including Apollo Tyres, JK Tyre, and CEAT—have made substantial investments in manufacturing facilities near Chennai. Together, these three companies have invested close to ₹12,000 crore, with CEAT currently undertaking a fresh expansion worth ₹1,314 crore.

Global players are also strengthening their footprint. France-based Michelin has positioned Chennai as a strategic production hub, investing around ₹3,400 crore in its Thervoy Kandigai facility. In recent quarters, factories around Chennai have expanded not only in scale, but also in sophistication, steadily enhancing capabilities alongside capacity.

"Our Oragadam plant has emerged as a flagship facility, producing premium, high-performance radial tyres for passenger vehicles as well as truck and bus segments. Equipped with advanced automation and manufacturing technologies, the plant enables the company to move up the value chain into higher-margin, technologically advanced tyres, which are increasingly in demand from both domestic and global automobile manufacturers," said Neeraj Kanwar, VC & MD of Apollo Tyres.

Apollo Tyres has so far invested around ₹5,500 crore in its Chennai operations, with an annual capacity of 5.4



QUALITY FOCUS: TN is a top-tier exporter

million passenger car radial tyres and 4.4 million commercial vehicle tyres. The company is now sharpening its focus on R&D, particularly in Chennai.

According to Anshuman Singhania, MD of JK Tyre, the company's Chennai facility plays a critical role in its portfolio, contributing about 26% to overall

production and revenue. It has invested more than ₹2,600 crore in the plant, which has a capacity of 350 tonnes per day for passenger car and truck and bus radial tyres. In recent years, JK Tyre has upgraded the facility to focus on premium products while also advancing sustainability initiatives, including tyres made with up to 80% sustainable and recycled materials.

Mumbai-headquartered CEAT is expanding its Chennai operations with a ₹1,314 crore capex plan approved earlier this year. The expansion, to be completed in phases by the second half of FY28, will add capacity for 3.5 million passenger car tyres. The plant has also introduced a new production line for truck and bus radial tyres and adopted AI and IoT-driven manufacturing practices. Its production capabilities have expanded significantly, from about 100 types of tyres in 2020 to nearly 350 currently.

Premiumisation has emerged as a key trend in the automotive sector, driven by

rising safety awareness and increasing demand for larger rim sizes, higher-performance tyres, and lower rolling resistance. Also, growing acceptance of Indian tyres in overseas markets has prompted manufacturers to build dedicated export capacities, particularly for premium products, which offer better realisations and higher margins, said K Srikumar, Sr VP & Co-Group Head, Icara.

Homegrown leaders such as MRF and TVS Srichakra continue to reinforce Tamil Nadu's manufacturing base. MRF is preparing to set up a new facility in the state, while TVS Srichakra, after completing a ₹1,000 crore capacity expansion, is pursuing further brownfield expansions and planning its entry into the tractor tyre segment.

Meanwhile, Michelin has transformed its Chennai plant into a key global manufacturing hub, producing around 54,000 tonnes of tyres annually across multiple segments, including truck, bus, and passenger vehicles.

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22-Mar-2026	The Times of India	Tyre makers move up the value chain—via TN	Online

Edition  IN English  Weather

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Tyre makers move up the value chain—via TN

G Balachandrar / Mar 22, 2026, 23:45 IST

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**CHENNAI
NEWS**

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